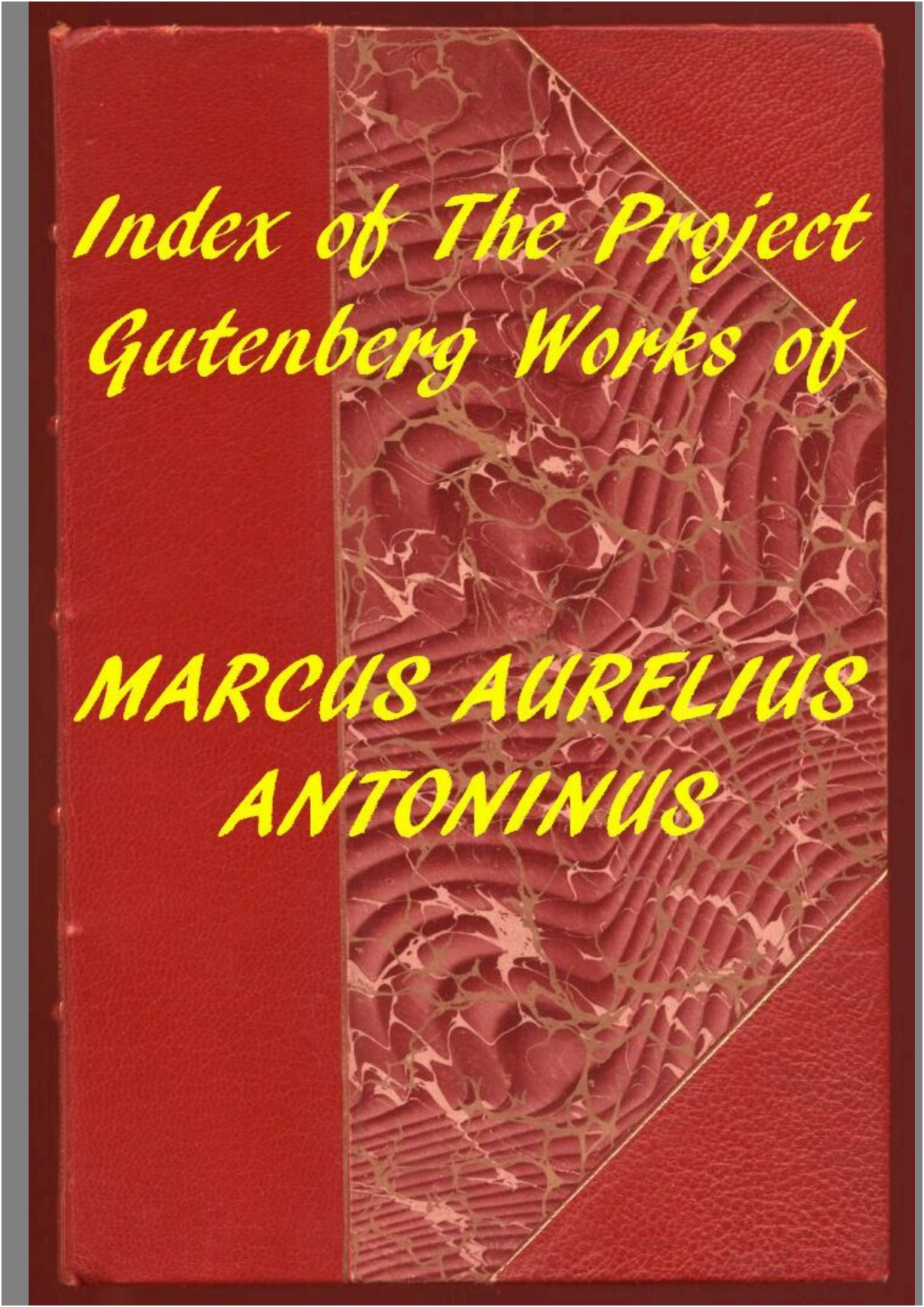


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**WORKS OF
MARCUS AURELIUS
ANTONINUS**

Compiled by David Widger



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VI. To be cheerful, and to stand in no need, either of other men's help

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VIII. Never esteem of anything as profitable, which shall ever constrain

IX. In the mind that is once truly disciplined and purged, thou canst

X. Use thine opinative faculty with all honour and respect, for in

XI. To these ever-present helps and mementoes, let one more be added,

XII. What is this, that now my fancy is set upon? of what things doth

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VI. Such and such things, from such and such causes, must of necessity

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X. These two rules, thou must have always in a readiness. First, do

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XX. They will say commonly, Meddle not with many things, if thou wilt
XXI. Try also how a good man's life; (of one, who is well pleased with
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XXXII. In another man's mind and understanding thy evil Cannot subsist,
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XLI. Oh, wretched I, to whom this mischance is happened! nay, happy I,
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XLIII. Let thy course ever be the most compendious way. The most

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I. In the morning when thou findest thyself unwilling to rise, consider

II. How easy a thing is it for a man to put off from him all turbulent

III. Think thyself fit and worthy to speak, or to do anything that is

IV. I continue my course by actions according to nature, until I

V. No man can admire thee for thy sharp acute language, such is thy

VI. Such there be, who when they have done a good turn to any, are ready

VII. The form of the Athenians' prayer did run thus: 'O rain, rain, good

VIII. As we say commonly, The physician hath prescribed unto this man,

IX. Be not discontented, be not disheartened, be not out of hope, if

X. Thou must comfort thyself in the expectation of thy natural

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XII. What those things are in themselves, which by the greatest part are

XIII. All that I consist of, is either form or matter. No corruption can

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XXII. Be not angry neither with him whose breath, neither with him whose

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XXVII. Within a very little while, thou wilt be either ashes, or a

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XI. How marvellous useful it is for a man to represent unto himself
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XXIX. Stir up thy mind, and recall thy wits again from thy natural
XXX. I consist of body and soul. Unto my body all things are
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XXXII. Dost thou not see, how even those that profess mechanic arts,
XXXIII. Asia, Europe; what are they, but as corners of the whole world;
XXXIV He that seeth the things that are now, hath Seen all that either
XXXV. Fit and accommodate thyself to that estate and to those
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XLII. Let the several deaths of men of all sorts, and of all sorts of
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XLIX. That which is not good for the bee-hive, cannot be good for the
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LII. To them that are sick of the jaundice, honey seems bitter; and to
LIII. No man can hinder thee to live as thy nature doth require. Nothing
LIV. What manner of men they be whom they seek to please, and what to

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I. What is wickedness? It is that which many time and often thou hast
II. What fear is there that thy dogmata, or philosophical resolutions
III. That which most men would think themselves most happy for, and
IV. Word after word, every one by itself, must the things that are
V. Is my reason, and understanding sufficient for this, or no? If it be
VI. Let not things future trouble thee. For if necessity so require that
VII. Whatsoever is material, doth soon vanish away into the common
VIII. To a reasonable creature, the same action is both according

IX. Straight of itself, not made straight.

X. As several members in one body united, so are reasonable creatures

XI. Of things that are external, happen what will to that which can

XII. Whatsoever any man either doth or saith, thou must be good; not for

XIII. This may ever be my comfort and security: my understanding, that

XIV. What is rrv&nfLovia, or happiness: but a7~o~ &d~wv, or, a good

XV. Is any man so foolish as to fear change, to which all things that

XVI. Through the substance of the universe, as through a torrent pass

XVII. The nature of the universe, of the common substance of all things

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XIX. Whensoever any man doth trespass against other, presently consider

XX. Fancy not to thyself things future, as though they were present

XXI. Wipe off all opinion stay the force and violence of unreasonable

XXII. All things (saith he) are by certain order and appointment. And

XXIII. Out of Plato. 'He then whose mind is endowed with true

XXIV. Out of Antisthenes. 'It is a princely thing to do well, and to be

XXV. Out of several poets and comics. 'It will but little avail thee,

XXVI. Out of Plato. 'My answer, full of justice and equity, should be

XXVII. To look back upon things of former ages, as upon the manifold

XXVIII. He hath a stronger body, and is a better wrestler than I. What

XXIX. Where the matter may be effected agreeably to that reason, which

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XXXI. As one who had lived, and were now to die by right, whatsoever is

XXXII. Thou must use thyself also to keep thy body fixed and steady;

XXXIII. The art of true living in this world is more like a wrestler's,

XXXIV. Thou must continually ponder and consider with thyself, what

XXXV. What pain soever thou art in, let this presently come to thy mind,

XXXVI. Take heed lest at any time thou stand so affected, though towards

XXXVII. How know we whether Socrates were so eminent indeed, and of so

XXXVIII. For it is a thing very possible, that a man should be a very

XXXIX. Free from all compulsion in all cheerfulness and alacrity thou
XL. Then hath a man attained to the estate of perfection in his life and
XLI. Can the Gods, who are immortal, for the continuance of so many
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XLII. What object soever, our reasonable and sociable faculty doth meet

XLIII. When thou hast done well, and another is benefited by thy action,

XLIV. The nature of the universe did once certainly before it was

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I. This also, among other things, may serve to keep thee from vainglory;

II. Upon every action that thou art about, put this question to thyself;

III. Alexander, Caius, Pompeius; what are these to Diogenes, Heraclitus,

IV. What they have done, they will still do, although thou shouldst hang

V. That which the nature of the universe doth busy herself about, is;

VI. Every particular nature hath content, when in its own proper course

VII. Thou hast no time nor opportunity to read. What then? Hast thou

VIII. Forbear henceforth to complain of the trouble of a courtly life,

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XIV. Remember, that to change thy mind upon occasion, and to follow
him

XV. If it were thine act and in thine own power, wouldest thou do

XVI. Whatsoever dieth and falleth, however and wheresoever it die

XVII. Whatsoever is, was made for something: as a horse, a vine. Why

XVIII. Nature hath its end as well in the end and final consummation of

XIX. As one that tosseth up a ball. And what is a ball the better, if

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LIV. The sun seemeth to be shed abroad. And indeed it is diffused but

LV. He that feareth death, either feareth that he shall have no sense at
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II. It were indeed more happy and comfortable, for a man to depart out
III. Thou must not in matter of death carry thyself scornfully, but as
IV. He that sinneth, sinneth unto himself. He that is unjust, hurts
V. If my present apprehension of the object be right, and my present
VI. To wipe away fancy, to use deliberation, to quench concupiscence, to
VII. Of all unreasonable creatures, there is but one unreasonable soul;
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IX. Either teach them better if it be in thy power; or if it be not,
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XI. This day I did come out of all my trouble. Nay I have cast out all
XII. All those things, for matter of experience are usual and ordinary;
XIII. The things themselves that affect us, they stand without doors,
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XXX. Many of those things that trouble and straiten thee, it is in thy
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I. O my soul, the time I trust will be, when thou shalt be good, simple,
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III. Whatsoever doth happen unto thee, thou art naturally by thy natural
IV. Him that offends, to teach with love and meekness, and to show him
V. Whatsoever it be that happens unto thee, it is that which from all
VI. Either with Epicurus, we must fondly imagine the atoms to be the
VII. All parts of the world, (all things I mean that are contained
VIII. Now that thou hast taken these names upon thee of good, modest,
IX. Toys and fooleries at home, wars abroad: sometimes terror, sometimes
X. As the spider, when it hath caught the fly that it hunted after, is
XI. To find out, and set to thyself some certain way and method of
XII. He hath got loose from the bonds of his body, and perceiving that
XIII. What use is there of suspicion at all? or, why should thoughts
XIV. What is that that is slow, and yet quick? merry, and yet grave? He

XV. In the morning as soon as thou art awaked, when thy judgment, before

XVI. Give what thou wilt, and take away what thou wilt, saith he that is

XVII. So live as indifferent to the world and all worldly objects, as

XVIII. Make it not any longer a matter of dispute or discourse, what are

XIX. Ever to represent unto thyself; and to set before thee, both the

XX. Consider them through all actions and occupations, of their lives:

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XXIII. Either thou dost Continue in this kind of life and that is it,

XXIV Let it always appear and be manifest unto thee that solitariness,

XXV. He that runs away from his master is a fugitive. But the law is

XXVI. From man is the seed, that once cast into the womb man hath no

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XXX. When thou art offended with any man's transgression, presently

XXXI. When thou seest Satyro, think of Socraticus and Eutyches, or

XXXII. What a subject, and what a course of life is it, that thou doest

XXXIII. Let it not be in any man's power, to say truly of thee, that

XXXIV. As he that is bitten by a mad dog, is afraid of everything almost

XXXV. A good eye must be good to see whatsoever is to be seen, and not

XXXVI. There is not any man that is so happy in his death, but that some

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II. A pleasant song or dance; the Pancratiast's exercise, sports that

III. That soul which is ever ready, even now presently (if need be) from

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VII. A branch cut off from the continuity of that which was next unto
VIII. To grow together like fellow branches in matter of good
IX. It is not possible that any nature should be inferior unto art,
X. The things themselves (which either to get or to avoid thou art put
XI. Then is the soul as Empedocles doth liken it, like unto a sphere or
XII. Will any condemn me? let him look to that, upon what grounds he
XIII. They condemn one another, and yet they seek to please one another:
XIV. How rotten and insincere is he, that saith, I am resolved to carry
XV. To live happily is an inward power of the soul, when she is affected
XVI. Of everything thou must consider from whence it came, of what
XVII. Four several dispositions or inclinations there be of the mind and
XVIII. What portion soever, either of air or fire there be in thee,
XIX. He that hath not one and the self-same general end always as long
XX. Remember the fable of the country mouse and the city mouse, and
the
XXI. Socrates was wont to call the common conceits and opinions of
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XXII. The Lacedaemonians at their public spectacles were wont to
appoint
XXIII. What Socrates answered unto Perdiccas, why he did not come unto
XXIV. In the ancient mystical letters of the Ephesians, there was an
XXV. The Pythagoreans were wont betimes in the morning the first thing
XXVI. How Socrates looked, when he was fain to gird himself with a
XXVII. In matter of writing or reading thou must needs be taught before
XXVIII. 'My heart smiled within me.' 'They will accuse even virtue
XXIX. As they that long after figs in winter when they cannot be had; so
XXX. 'As often as a father kisseth his child, he should say secretly.
XXXI. 'Of the free will there is no thief or robber:' out of Epictetus;

THE TWELFTH BOOK

I. Whatsoever thou doest hereafter aspire unto, thou mayest even now
II. God beholds our minds and understandings, bare and naked from these
III. I have often wondered how it should come to pass, that every man

IV. how come it to pass that the Gods having ordered all other things
V. Use thyself even unto those things that thou doest at first despair
VI. Let these be the objects of thy ordinary meditation: to consider,
VII. All worldly things thou must behold and consider, dividing them
VIII. How happy is man in this his power that hath been granted unto
IX. Whatsoever doth happen in the ordinary course and consequence of
X. How ridiculous and strange is he, that wonders at anything that
XI. Either fate, (and that either an absolute necessity, and unavoidable
XII. At the conceit and apprehension that such and such a one hath
XIII. If it be not fitting, do it not. If it be not true, speak it not.
XIV. Of everything that presents itself unto thee, to consider what the
XV. It is high time for thee, to understand that there is somewhat in
XVI. Remember that all is but opinion, and all opinion depends of the
XVII. No operation whatsoever it be, ceasing for a while, can be truly
XVIII. These three things thou must have always in a readiness: first
XIX. Cast away from thee opinion, and thou art safe. And what is it that
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XXI. To them that ask thee, Where hast thou seen the Gods, or how
XXII. Herein doth consist happiness of life, for a man to know
XXIII. There is but one light of the sun, though it be intercepted by
XXIV. What doest thou desire? To live long. What? To enjoy the
XXV. What a small portion of vast and infinite eternity it is, that is
XXVI. What is the present estate of my understanding? For herein lieth
XXVII. To stir up a man to the contempt of death this among other

**THE THOUGHTS OF THE
EMPEROR**

**MARCUS AURELIUS
ANTONINUS**

By George Long

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